



Critical flaw in IoT

A couple of critical vulnerabilities in CODESYS Web Server could lead to making many IoT devices vulnerable. <http://dgit.in/IOTflaw>



Doomsday Vault expanding

Almost a decade after the original Svalbard seed vault opened its doors, Norway's Doomsday vault is being expanded <http://dgit.in/VaultExpand>

Bazaar

Sony Xperia XZs

Just short of great

The Sony Xperia XZs is the company's latest flagship smartphone in India, and is the first to unveil staggering slow motion videos at 960fps. It uses the new sensor with 19-megapixel effective resolution at 4:3 pillarboxing, along with an f/2.0 G lens and a faster BIONZ X image processor. The slow motion videos produced by the Xperia XZs, however, are erratic. With ample light in natural environments, the Sony Xperia XZs shoots stunning slow motion videos with no interpolation and stutters, and is a significant visual upgrade over the 120fps and 240fps slow motion videos produced by phones so far.

However, the algorithms struggle with shutter speed adjustment under fluorescent light due to flicker rate, and produce too much noise in low light. This limits places where you can use this mode.

The regular camera performance is significantly improved, with the predictive shooting coming into play when you are shooting in motion. Autofocus speed is also significantly faster, and all of these features make use of the higher DRAM in the stacked CMOS sensor to give a fast, smooth main camera. Colours are vibrant, offer high contrast and are well-detailed, and high dynamic range helps deeper range of colours and more details even in shadows. However, the slight strains of oversaturation cannot be ignored. Low light shooting, however, tends to produce more noise in Auto mode than optimum, which is the only loose end here.

The Sony Xperia XZs retains the same design as previous Xperia smartphones, which is a good thing. The 5.2-inch smartphone is light and ergonomic to hold. Button placement is also well-thought out and makes the phone easy to use. The sharp corners, however, will get chipped in mild drops, and the smooth metal surface along with rounded edges do not aid grip.

The display is crisp and bright, producing 705 lux of luminance, which is appreciable. The vibrant colours make video streaming and



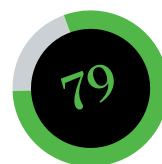
Price
₹49,990

gaming a great experience. Touch response is smooth and fluid, and the updated Xperia UI with Android Nougat retains all the goodness and the finesse of glass effects along with a few optimisations. The UI allows you to adjust the display's colours manually with an RGB toggle, and override presets by choosing to use the X-Reality Mobile display engine. Other UI optimisations include Xperia Actions - a deep-integrated assistant that works in the background and suggests predictive actions for tasks that you usually do at a certain time, every day. It is non-intrusive and acts smoothly, and can be controlled manually any time.

Powered by an underclocked Qualcomm Snapdragon 820 SoC at 1.6GHz, 4GB RAM and 64GB native storage, the Sony Xperia XZs provides smooth overall performance despite running on a year-old processor. Most everyday apps like WhatsApp, Instagram, Gmail, Facebook and Chrome load without any delay at first, although with more than five apps open you get slight delays that are noticeable enough for discerning users. Gameplay is smooth and seamless, and although the device does heat up a bit, the interior heat pipes ensure device temperature remains with 41 degrees even after 30 minutes of gaming. The 2900mAh battery on the Sony Xperia XZs is supported by Qualcomm Quick-Charge 3.0 for fast charging and Qnovo Adaptive Charging to protect longevity. This programs the device to charge fast up to 90 percent in 45 minutes, after which it cuts off power supply to maintain battery health. The device lasts for 13 hours of average real time usage with intensive tasks, and a daily charge is necessary.

Despite being a fine smartphone with few flaws, the Sony Xperia XZs now runs on a processor that has already lived a year of its life cycle. The phone still offers sublime end-user experience, but with new flagships being launched, it becomes hard to recommend at ₹49,990.

Souvik Das



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Specifications

Processor: Qualcomm Snapdragon 820; **RAM:** 4GB; **Storage:** 64GB, expandable; **Primary camera:** 19MP with 960fps slow motion; **Front camera:** 13MP; **Display:** 5.2-inch, Full HD; **Battery:** 2900mAh, Qualcomm QuickCharge 3.0

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